

Why are leaves green?

Leaves are green because they contain a green chemical called chlorophyll. Plants use chlorophyll to absorb sunlight so they can make food. This process is called photosynthesis. Photosynthesis takes place during the day when the Sun is out.

1 Carbon dioxide in

During the day, leaves take in carbon dioxide from the air, water from the tree's roots, and sunlight. They mix them together to make sugar and oxygen.

2 Oxygen out

The leaves release the oxygen they have made, because they do not need it, and store the sugar for food.

Quick quiz

-  What is photosynthesis?
-  What does a tree's roots take in?
-  Why does a tree take in oxygen?

Spreading out.....

A tree's roots may reach deep down or spread far and wide to gather as much water as possible.

